

SoDamHarness Beginner Guide 🛑 (English)

한국어 가이드: **GUIDE.md** (Korean is the primary, authoritative version) · Short intro: **README.en.md** · How to test: **TESTING.en.md** This guide assumes you are **new to coding, AI, and even computers/phones**. Hard terms are explained, and you can follow it one **"click this now"** step at a time.

0. What is this? (1-minute idea)

- **SoDamHarness** = a **"safety belt"** that prevents accidents when you let an AI do computer tasks.
 - It is a **one-click add-on (plugin)** for the AI coding tool **Claude Code**.
 - Like a car seatbelt, it stays **quiet** normally and only **stops, asks, and backs up first** at the **dangerous moment** when the AI is about to delete or overwrite files.
- 💡 Terms: **plugin** = an add-on that gives a program extra features. **AI coding tool** = a program that does computer work when you ask in plain language.

1. Prerequisites (programs you need)

Needed	What it is	Check / Install
Claude Code	The AI coding tool this belt attaches to	OK if you already use it
Node.js (18+)	The "engine" that runs the safety features	See 1-1
OS	Windows or Mac	Both supported (verified on Windows; Mac uses the same code, real-device check pending)

1-1. Install Node.js (only if missing)

1. In a browser, go to <https://nodejs.org>.
 2. Of the two big buttons, click the one marked **"LTS"** to download.
 3. Double-click the downloaded installer → keep clicking **"Next"** to install.
 4. Verify: in Claude Code type `node --version` → if numbers like `v18...` appear, success.
- ⚠ Without Node.js the safety features **silently do not run**. Install it first.

2. Download & Install (click by click)

Installing is **4 steps**: ① **add marketplace** → ② **install plugin** → ③ **restart** → ④ **verify**. Pick whichever is easier.

Method A — via menu (mouse/arrow keys, easiest)

1. **Open Claude Code.**
2. Type `/plugin` and press Enter → the plugin management screen opens.
3. Under **Add marketplace**, enter `sodam-ai/SoDam-Harness-Eng` to add it.
4. From the plugin list, pick `sodam-harness` and **Install** it.

Method B — by command (precise)

Prefix each line with `!` in the input box (or run without `!` in a terminal):

1. `!claude plugin marketplace add sodam-ai/SoDam-Harness-Eng`
2. `!claude plugin install sodam-harness@sodamharness-marketplace`

③ Restart (required) — the belt arms only on start

- Type `/exit` → Claude Code shuts down.
- Then type `claude` in the terminal to start it again. (Or close and reopen the terminal window.)

④ Verify

- Type `/sodam-harness:install` → when "the safety belt is on " appears, install is done.
- If you don't see it, type just `/sodam-harness` → if 5 commands appear, it's working.

 **Private beta:** for now the repo (`sodam-ai/SoDam-Harness-Eng`) requires **access** to add. Once public, anyone can install with the steps above.  On first run, Windows **SmartScreen** or Mac **Gatekeeper** may warn you. If from the **official source**, click "Run anyway". (If suspicious, stop.)

3. Quick start (5 minutes)

The easiest way is to **just ask the AI in plain language**.

1. Make a **throwaway empty practice folder** and open Claude Code inside it.
2. Type: **"Make a simple intro page here."** → the AI creates files (safe action, not blocked).
3. Try something risky: **"Delete this whole folder."** → the belt **blocks it**, saying **"Deleting a whole folder is blocked."**
4. Delete one file: **"Delete the file I just made."** → it is **auto-backed-up** right before deletion.
5. Undo: `/sodam-harness:undo` → **pick what you just lost** from the backup list to restore.

4. How to use / how it works

-  **Plain tone** — the AI explains in **easy words** instead of jargon. (If it gets hard, say **"Explain it simply"**.)
-  **Block / confirm** — risky work stops **before** running.
 - **Whole-folder / recursive deletion** (irreversible) is **blocked outright**.
 - **File delete / overwrite** is **backed up first**, then **"Are you sure?" confirmed**.
-  **Auto-backup** — right **before** a risky action, the target file is copied to the backup folder.
-  **Undo** — shows the **backup list** and lets you **pick what you just lost** to restore (so it never restores the wrong thing even when tasks are mixed).
-  **Self-check** — tells you the current state and "what to do next".

⚠️ **Important (auto-approve mode):** if you run Claude Code in **"auto-approve" mode**, the "Are you sure?" prompt may pass automatically. Even so, **big risks like whole-folder deletion are still blocked**. To always see the prompt, use Claude Code's **default mode**.

Workflow

Install → (ask the AI in plain language) → on risky action: stop, back up, confirm
→ if an accident happens, `/sodam-harness:undo` to restore
→ if stuck, `/sodam-harness:status (state) · /sodam-harness:fix (troubleshoot)`

5. Commands

Command	When to use	What happens
<code>/sodam-harness:install</code>	Right after install	Confirms install + getting-started guide
<code>/sodam-harness:status</code>	When unsure it works	Health check + "what to do next"
<code>/sodam-harness:fix</code>	When something breaks	Symptom-based help
<code>/sodam-harness:undo</code>	After an accidental delete	Restore by picking from the backup list

6. File / document locations

- **Backup folder (auto-created)** — inside your home folder, `.sodamharness/backups/`
 - Windows: `C:\Users\<name>\.sodamharness\backups\`
 - Mac: `/Users/<name>/.sodamharness/backups/`
 - This folder **never stores passwords/tokens**. Only backup files.
- **Documents (in this project)**
 - `README.md` / `README.en.md` — short intro (KO/EN)
 - `GUIDE.md` / `GUIDE.en.md` — this detailed guide (KO/EN)
 - `TESTING.md` / `TESTING.en.md` — how to test/verify (KO/EN)
 - `LICENSE` / `NOTICE` — license & notices

7. Troubleshooting (Symptom → Why → Do now)

Symptom	Why	Do now
Risky action wasn't stopped	Plugin off, or an unknown risk pattern	Restart Claude Code → <code>/sodam-harness:status</code>
Installed but no effect	Didn't restart	Fully close and reopen Claude Code

Symptom	Why	Do now
Asks too often	Safety-first (L1) default	Adjust strength once used to it (coming later)
"Node.js missing"	The safety hook runs on Node	Install LTS from https://nodejs.org , then restart
Run-block warning (SmartScreen/Gatekeeper)	OS asks once for a new program	If from the official source, "Run anyway"
Want to undo	—	<code>/sodam-harness:undo</code> (pick from the list)
Backup folder error (permission/space)	Disk full / permissions	Free space and retry (if backup fails, the risky action is auto-stopped)
Garbled Korean	Encoding	Usually fine (Node.js); otherwise <code>/sodam-harness:fix</code>
Explanations too hard (tone)	The easy tone is via a Skill and may not always auto-activate	Tell the AI "Explain it simply"

8. Uninstall

1. In Claude Code, `/plugin` → **Uninstall SoDamHarness**. Or type `!claude plugin uninstall sodam-harness@sodamharness-marketplace`.
2. To delete backups too, remove the `.sodamharness/` folder in your home directory. (Leave it to keep your backups.)

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10. FAQ

- **Q. Is it truly safe?** — It blocks common risks but **cannot block 100% of all cases**. It is a "seatbelt", not a "bulletproof shield".
- **Q. Does it see my passwords/tokens?** — **No**. It doesn't access tokens/auth files and doesn't send data out.
- **Q. Do I need the internet?** — Only to install. The safety features run locally on your computer.
- **Q. I accidentally deleted a folder.** — Folders can't be backed up wholesale, so **folder deletion itself is blocked**. Files can be restored with `/sodam-harness:undo`.